BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
42D AIR BASE WING (AETC)

MAXWELL AFB INSTRUCTION 34-242

16 NOVEMBER 2011

Services

BASE HONOR GUARD PROGRAM

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing web site at **www.e-publishing.af.mil** for downloading or ordering.

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasibility restrictions on this publication.

OPR: 42 FSS/FSOMX

Certified by: 42 FSS/CC
(Major Natalie K. Jolly)
Pages: 21

This instruction implements AFI 34-242, *Mortuary Affairs Program*. It establishes policies and procedures, providing guidance for planning, training and using the Maxwell AFB Honor Guard. It describes the functions of the honor guard (42 FSS/FSOMX), responsibilities of honor guard members, procedures for performing honor guard functions and participation standards. It adds internal communication titles and chain of command procedures. Refer recommended changes and/or corrections to this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*, through your chain of command. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Manual (AFMAN) 33-363, *Management of Records*, and disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Information Management System (AFRIMS) Records Disposition Schedule (RDS) located at **https://www.my.af.mil/afrims/afrims/afrims/rims.cfm**. This instruction applies to all personnel assigned to the honor guard and all agencies supported by or supporting the honor guard. It applies to the 908th Air Wing (AFRC) and the 187th Fighter Wing (ANG) only to the extent of being eligible to receive Honor Guard support.

1. Functions. 2
2. Manning and Obligations. 3
3. Organization and Responsibilities. 6
4. On-Duty Month and Training. 8
Table 4.1. Flight Schedule. 9
5. Scheduling and Participation. 9

6. Uniforms. 11
7. Equipment. 12
8. Weapons Storage. 12
9. Weapons Maintenance. 12
10. Transportation. 13
11. Benefits and Awards. 13
12. Performance Feedback. 14
13. Honor Guard Details. 14
14. Honors, Awards and Ceremonies. 14
15. The 42d Air Base Wing Commander (42 ABW/CC). 14
16. The Wing Chaplain. 15
17. The 42d Mission Support Group Commander (42 MSG/CC). 15
18. The 42d Force Support Squadron Commander (42 FSS/CC). 15

Attachment 1—GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION 16

Attachment 2—EXAMPLE HONOR GUARD DUTY STATEMENT OF UNDERSTANDING 18

1. Functions. The Maxwell AFB Honor Guard is an elite team comprised of members from the 42d Air Base Wing (42 ABW), HQ Air University (AU) and tenant units. The team supports 54 counties in the state of Alabama and 4 counties in Georgia, including Alabama National Cemetery and Ft. Mitchell National Cemetery, ranging approximately 58,000 square miles.

1.1. Historically, the honor guard supports over 500 requests annually to include:

1.1.1. Military funerals and memorial services. For procedural guidelines, see the USAF Honor Guard Basic Protocol, Honors and Ceremonies Training guide, available at **http://www.honorguard.af.mil/**.

1.1.2. Change of command, retirement and awards ceremonies (See AFMAN 36-2203, *Drill and Ceremonies*).

1.2. Appropriate military honors at funerals or memorial services and ceremonies when requested by the installation commander, base mortuary officer, person authorized direct disposition (PADD) or the next of kin (NOK) of a deceased military member:

1.2.1. US Air Force active duty or U.S. Air Force Medal of Honor recipients, within the jurisdiction of Maxwell AFB, as specified by the Military Honors Assignment by County Documents, issued by HQ Air Force Mortuary Operations Center. (**AFMAO.MAD@dover.af.mil**).

1.2.2. Deceased U.S. Air Force retired and veteran personnel within the county area will receive the authorized military honors.

1.2.3. Provide honors as authorized by AFI 34-242, *Mortuary Affairs Program*, and AFPAM 34-505, *Mortuary Services Benefits for Retired Air Force Members*.

1.2.4. NOK of deceased personnel of sister services, where practical, will be referred to the nearest military activity of the same service as the deceased.

1.2.5. Funeral and memorial services and other ceremonies requiring honor guard participation may be scheduled for any day of the week or year.

1.3. Priority of Details.

1.3.1. Funerals and memorial services are top priority for the honor guard under guidance provided in paragraph 1.2. In the case of dual funerals where the on-duty flight needs more personnel, the primary stand-by flight will be tasked first then the alternate stand-by flight. In the case of multiple services or an active duty funeral conflicting with another memorial service, members from all flights may be tasked.

1.3.2. The mortuary affairs office (42 FSS/FSOM) will attempt to reschedule any overlapping funerals in coordination with the funeral home, the PADD/NOK and the honor guard Superintendent or designee.

1.3.3. The Maxwell AFB Honor Guard will only accommodate requests for military and civilian ceremonies listed below with the understanding that funeral honors take precedence. Details will be based on the following priority and flight tasking:

1.3.3.1. Colors for change of command for AU/CC and 42 ABW/CC through the tasking of all flights.

1.3.3.2. Cordons for dignitaries, colors for wing-level events, assistance for retreats during military holidays (when requested by the 42 ABW/CC), colors for other special events for the base, colors for flag officers/colonel/CMSgt retirements on base through the tasking of on-duty, primary and alternate stand-by flights.

1.3.3.3. Colors for all other retirements on base, colors for special community events within a 20-mile radius of Maxwell AFB, colors for local military events through the tasking of on-duty and primary stand-by flights.

1.3.3.4. Colors for non-military events outside the 20-mile radius of Maxwell AFB through the tasking of on-duty flight or honor guard volunteers.

1.3.4. All other requests will be considered on a case-by-case basis by 42 FSS/FSOMX. The decision will be based on input from the on-duty flight chief with reference to the current schedule, honor guard manning, location of event, type of event and requester.

2. Manning and Obligations. The Maxwell AFB Honor Guard will be manned with personnel (E-1 through E-6) selected from units on base. Selection will be based on unit strength versus base population provided by the 42d Force Support Squadron Commander (42 FSS/CC) and approved by 42 ABW/CC.

2.1. The honor guard will be composed of 4 flights of 10 members each: 1 flight on-duty, 1 off-duty, 1 on primary stand-by and 1 on alternate stand-by. Additionally, if there is a need, personnel from all flights may be tasked to perform duties to support mission requirements. The number of personnel per flight may change based on mission needs. Full time equivalent levels will be staffed through manpower.

2.2. Prior to selection as an honor guard member, the applicant must complete an Honor Guard Statement of Understanding and forward it to 42 FSS/FSOMX. The applicant must have approval of both his/her unit commander and first sergeant.

2.3. Personnel selected for honor guard incur a minimum 12-month commitment.

2.4. Unit commanders and first sergeants will seek volunteers or appoint members who meet the following criteria:

2.4.1. Minimum of 12 months retainability (may be waived by 42 MSG/CC).

2.4.2. Are of the highest caliber in metal health, bearing, appearance, behavior and attitude.

2.4.3. No non-judicial punishment under Article 15, Uniform Code of Military Justice, pending or completed in the past year, no control roster or Unfavorable Information File.

2.4.4. Meet or exceed the Air Force Fitness Assessment and maintains a Fit to Fight image.

2.4.5. Not on a shaving waiver.

2.4.6. Not pregnant.

2.4.7. Not on a profile.

2.5. Prior to selection to the honor guard, volunteers or selects will report to the honor guard Officer in Charge (OIC)/Superintendent in full service dress for an interview. The honor guard OIC/Superintendent will review dress and appearance, and customs and courtesies to gain an overall image of the prospective recruit. If the honor guard OIC/Superintendent feels that the prospective recruit doesn't project the proper military image, he/she will forward their findings to the unit's first sergeant to discuss other possibilities.

2.6. Once the nominee has passed the interview process, he/she will then enter the training phase. If the nominee has difficulty mastering any of the movements, it is at the discretion of the honor guard OIC/Superintendent to approve/disapprove the member for selection. The honor guard OIC/Superintendent will then forward the findings to the unit's first sergeant to discuss other possibilities.

2.7. Two months prior to expiration of the member's 12-month service commitment, the honor guard OIC/Superintendent will notify the member's first sergeant of the need to identify a replacement or continue the member's service for no less than 6 months.

2.7.1. In the event of a temporary duty assignment (TDY) that prevents the member from serving their full term, the term of service will be extended equal to the time the member was TDY (i.e., if the member is TDY for 3 months, the term of service will be extended 3 months). Based on manning requirements, the honor guard OIC/Superintendent may request the unit to provide a replacement for the TDY member.

2.7.2. In the event of a permanent change of station (PCS) or hardship that precludes the member from serving their full term, the respective unit will replace the member 30 days in advance to allow for proper training, orientation, uniform procurement and fitting.

2.7.3. If a member appointed by the unit does not meet the requirements of paragraph 2.4., is for any reason unable to perform assigned duties or does not complete their term of service, the unit appointing the member will be required to reimburse 42 FSS/CC for the expenses to outfit another member from the unit with honor guard uniforms. This requirement may be waived by the 42 MSG/CC for just cause.

2.8. The Maxwell AFB Honor Guard Team is mandated by Congress to cover 100 percent of funeral honors with teams sufficiently trained, including simultaneous honors in several distant locations. Any or all of the below listed elements will be furnished within the guidelines of paragraph 1.2. upon request of the PADD/NOK or requester.

2.8.1. For an active duty funeral, there will be a minimum 20-member team assigned. Positions consist of an OIC or Non-commissioned officer in charge (NCOIC), six pallbearers, an NCOIC of firing party (NFP), seven firing party members, four members on color guard and a bugler. A ceremonial bugle insert or a recorded version of "Taps" may be played with concurrence of the PADD/NOK.

2.8.2. For a retiree funeral, there will be a minimum seven member team assigned. Positions consist of six pallbearers and NFP. The NCOIC of the pallbearers (NPB) will double as the detail NCOIC. Carry, Mark and Hand-off will perform as firing party members. Cross-Mark will double as stand-by. Fold will double as bugler. The NFP will position him/herself at their predetermined position and will remain there during the ceremony. A ceremonial bugle insert or a recorded version of "Taps" may be played with concurrence of the PADD/NOK.

2.8.3. For a veteran funeral, there will be a minimum of two members assigned. They will fold and present the flag and play "Taps". A ceremonial bugle insert or a recorded version of "Taps" may be played with concurrence of the PADD/NOK.

2.8.4. The minimum personnel requirements for each funeral element are as follows:

2.8.4.1. Color Guard. The Color Guard will consist of two flag bearers and two guards as required by AFI 34-242. The Color Guard will carry both the ceremonial U.S. Flag and the ceremonial Air Force flag (provisional). When the situation dictates, a three-member Color Guard may be used and will carry only the U.S. Flag.

2.8.4.2. Firing Party. The firing party will consist of four members. One member will perform as NCOIC (NFP) and three members perform as the firing party. The firing party is armed with M-14 rifles (or other authorized weapon) and blank ammunition.

2.8.4.3. Flag Folders and Pallbearers. The pallbearers will consist of six members and will also perform the flag fold for active duty and retiree funerals.

2.8.4.4. OIC or NCOIC. An OIC or NCOIC will be provided for each ceremony.

2.8.4.5. Bugler. If a contract bugler is not available, a ceremonial bugle insert or a recorded version of "Taps" may be played with concurrence of the PADD/NOK. If a tape/CD will be used, the tape/CD player will be out of sight of the funeral party.

2.8.4.6. The member presenting the flag to the NOK during an active duty funeral will be of equal or higher grade to that of the deceased. If the deceased is retired or a veteran, the flight chief will select the best qualified honor guard member to present the flag.

3. Organization and Responsibilities. The honor guard will consist of the following structure: The mortuary affairs officer (42 FSS/FSOM), honor guard OIC (42 FSS/FSOMX), honor guard Superintendent (42 FSS/FSOMX), and four flights (A, B, C and D). Each flight will have a flight chief (must be an NCO), an assistant flight chief (NCO recommended), a flight trainer and honor guard members. The honor guard Superintendent is a full-time position. The honor guard Superintendent shall not be tasked with other additional duties not directly related to base honor guard duties and responsibilities.

3.1. The 42 FSS/FSOMX will:

3.1.1. Be the primary point of contact for all honor guard requests.

3.1.2. Maintain honor guard member rosters.

3.1.3. Document all administrative and disciplinary actions.

3.1.4. Make written recommendations when further administrative, disciplinary action or removal action is warranted.

3.1.5. Prepare annual budget requirements for the base honor guard and authorized provider expenses.

3.1.6. Evaluate unit requirements for honor guard manning at least quarterly or more often where necessary.

3.1.7. Be the point of contact for each squadron affected by this instruction. The honor guard OIC/Superintendent will maintain an up-to-date list of personnel, qualifications and training attendance.

3.1.8. Initiate AF Form 1946, *Honor Guard Checklist*, upon an individual's request for honors and ensure it is properly completed after each detail.

3.1.9. Ensure data is recorded in the Funeral Honors Database (FHDB) and the funeral honors request telephone number is kept current.

3.1.10. Provide the means to take funeral honors requests 24 hours a day, 7 days a week and respond to all requests not more than 8 hours after the call comes in.

3.1.11. Monitor each honor guard member's continued acceptability on the team. In the event a member is considered unsuitable for continued duty, 42 FSS/FSOMX will, based on the recommendation of the flight chief, advise the member's first sergeant in writing of the circumstances leading to the termination and request an immediate replacement.

3.1.12. E-mail flight duty requirement schedules to all squadrons to keep them informed when their personnel are on-duty or standby.

3.1.13. Maintain current list of honor guard members for awards program. Keep dates current to reflect end of Honor Guard tour, PCS or separation and initiate paperwork for awards and decorations in a timely manner.

3.1.14. Ensure honor guard members and other authorized providers are trained and properly equipped to perform military funeral honors.

3.1.15. Approve and maintain a list of performance-ready, trained, uniformed and equipped honor guard members.

3.1.16. Schedule with Security Forces and ensure that honor guard weapons are inspected annually and certified for weapon safety and usability.

3.1.17. Forecast all ammunition requirements for the base honor guard and ensure that results are submitted to 42 LGS/LGRMS as requested.

3.1.18. Ensure all honor guard members are outfitted with ceremonial uniforms no later than 30 days after assignment.

3.2. Flight Chief. These individuals have the responsibility for the efficient operation and conduct during military ceremonies. This includes all activities conducted by the duty flight. The flight chief is responsible for coordinating the detail and all actions before the detail begins, during the actual detail and ending when the honor guard members return to Maxwell AFB and turn in all equipment. The flight chief is in charge of the overall performance, discipline, appearance and competence of their flight members. The flight chief will:

3.2.1. Support and assist the honor guard OIC/Superintendent.

3.2.2. Ensure honor guard members properly perform all assigned duties.

3.2.3. Conduct flight, vehicle and facility inspections during the on-duty month to ensure compliance with current requirements and regulations.

3.2.4. Notify the honor guard OIC/Superintendent of noncompliance with this instruction by flight personnel.

3.2.5. Ensure availability of personnel and equipment by maintaining close coordination with the honor guard Superintendent prior to the assigned detail.

3.2.6. Inspect participating honor guard members prior to leaving for the detail to ensure compliance with AFI 36-2903, *Dress and Personal Appearance of Air Force Personnel*. Ensure special uniform accessories are correctly worn and in serviceable condition. Enforce proper military image and honor guard discipline at all times. Correct and report any deviations to the honor guard OIC/Superintendent upon return.

3.2.7. Instruct and brief participating honor guard personnel on their assigned task for each ceremony. Arrive at least 1 hour prior to every detail to coordinate any special instructions with the requester and hold a practice ceremony prior to the arrival of those attending the ceremony.

3.2.8. Upon arrival to a detail, the flight chief or detail NCOIC will meet with the point of contact and discuss the requirements of the detail. The honor guard members will remain with the vehicle until equipment is unloaded, dress (if necessary) and wait for further information from the flight chief or detail NCOIC. Dressing rooms may be used if available.

3.2.9. Assign honor guard members to details based on abilities, skills, appearance, experience and frequency of details performed. Keep track of personnel performing details per type of detail and hours worked to include on- and off-duty hours. Flight chiefs will keep track of flight members missing drill practices and details. Members not meeting attendance requirements will be considered for corrective action. Flight chiefs will ensure that an NCO is assigned to each detail when possible.

3.2.10. Ensure adequate travel time is allotted for the team to arrive at detail location, proper coordination is made with the requester and practices are conducted before the actual detail is performed.

3.2.11. Ensure attendance is filed with AF IMT 1946 upon completion of each detail. Ensure the AF IMT 1946 is properly filled out and turned in to 42 FSS/FSOMX.

3.3. Honor guard members will:

3.3.1. Comply with the provisions of this instruction.

3.3.2. Coordinate with their flight chief and the honor guard OIC/Superintendent for scheduled leaves occurring during on-duty and stand-by periods.

3.3.3. Perform details as tasked by their flight chief unless properly excused.

3.3.4. Attend information and training meetings unless properly excused.

3.3.5. Become knowledgeable of all honor guard functions, formations, honors and ceremonies. Become proficient in performing all honor guard duties and drill and ceremonies. Perform movements with precision.

3.3.6. Ensure all equipment and vehicles entrusted are properly cared for and maintained. Honor guard members will assist the flight chief in maintaining equipment and supplies.

3.3.7. Ensure the honor guard training center is kept clean and well maintained with all equipment and materials returned to their proper place.

3.3.8. Maintain impeccable appearance and bearing and be in compliance with AFI 36-2903 and AFI 36-2905, *Fitness Program*, at all times. Ensure their uniforms are maintained in serviceable condition, attend training, master drill and know traditional formation ceremonies and protocol.

3.3.9. Notify their OIC/Superintendent and flight chief if they are scheduled for TDY, PCS or have made a decision to separate.

3.4. "No-Shows:" After a first "no-show," a letter will be sent to the individual's first sergeant. After second "no-show," the flight chief will issue a letter of counseling. After the third "no-show," the honor guard OIC/Superintendent will issue a letter of reprimand and provide a copy to the member's first sergeant.

4. On-Duty Month and Training. Each flight will fill 3 on-duty, 3 primary stand-by, 3 alternate stand-by and 3 off months in a 12 month period. Each flight will report 3 duty days at the end of each month for refresher training. On-duty and stand-by months begin at 0001 on the first calendar day and ends at 2400 on the last calendar day of the month. See Table 4.1.

Table 4.1. Flight Schedule.

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
On-Duty	A	C	B	D	A	C	B	D	A	C	B	D
Primary Stand-by	B	D	A	C	B	D	A	C	B	D	A	C
Alternate Standby	C	B	D	A	C	B	D	A	C	B	D	A
Off	D	A	C	B	D	A	C	B	D	A	C	B

4.1. Each flight will arrange member's schedules to support weekend and/or night details. Compensatory time is authorized, at the discretion of the flight chief and with coordination with the honor guard OIC/Superintendent.

4.2. Training will be standardized between all flights. At least once per quarter the flight chief and flight trainers will meet with the honor guard OIC/Superintendent and discuss training issues. Training will include the following areas:

4.2.1. Color Guard. To include proper positioning of flags, close interval marching, turning with and posting Colors and retreat procedures.

4.2.2. Firing Party. To include training in the use and care of the M-14 rifle or other authorized weapon rifle commands, fire arms safety, loading and firing positions in which the rifles are to be held.

4.2.3. Flag Folding. To include proper respect to the flag, positions of flag folders, proper procedures for folding the flag and procedures for presentation to the NOK.

4.2.4. Pallbearers. To include casket movement to and from the carrier (hearse), marching with the casket, casket placement at the site of service and honorary pallbearer duties.

4.2.5. Cordon and other applicable details will be trained periodically as needed.

4.3. Each flight will maintain the training area in pristine condition, including trash removal as necessary during their on-duty month. The flight chief will ensure the facility is cleaned prior to ending the on-duty month. Periodic inspections by honor guard OIC/Superintendent will occur.

4.4. In cases where two flights are combined for details, the flight chief of the on-duty flight will be the person in charge.

5. Scheduling and Participation. The honor guard duty month begins at 0001 on the first calendar day of the month and ends at 2400 on the last calendar day of the month, as stated in paragraph 4.

5.1. Scheduling and Reporting requirements:

5.1.1. When honor guard members are notified of a detail, they will report to the designated formation area and secure the necessary equipment. When reporting for a detail, all participants must be in strict compliance with AFI 36-2903 and may either be wearing the issued travel gear or the ceremonial uniform.

5.1.1.1. If the team is traveling more than 1 hour one way, they will wear travel gear. The travel gear will consist of the issued shirt worn with khaki/brown dress pants. The shirt will be tucked in and members will wear a conservative belt and shoes. The shoes must be black and must be in good repair. Members will not wear open toe shoes, sandals or shower shoes. Members will not wear hats or caps with their travel gear. Sunglasses will also be conservative in nature and meet specifications outlined in AFI 36-2903. The object is to present a clean, professional, military image to the public.

5.1.1.2. Air Force PT gear is authorized as a travel uniform with the T-shirts tucked in. Female hair will be secured above the collar IAW AFI 36-2903.

5.1.1.3. If the team is traveling 1 hour or less one way, they may wear their ceremonial uniform. Do not wear the service coat while traveling. The light weight blue jacket will be worn. Cover the ceremonial hat with a hat cover.

5.1.2. Honor guard members will keep the honor guard OIC/Superintendent and flight chief advised of their availability (TDY, changes in health profile, etc.). Leave during off-duty or stand-by months is encouraged but MUST be coordinated with the respective flight chief and the honor guard OIC/Superintendent to ensure proper manning levels are met. Leave during on-duty months is not recommended and will be addressed on an individual bases.

5.1.3. Honor guard members are exempt from security forces augmentation, Search & Recovery and other long term details during their commitment to Honor Guard. During the on-duty month, a member's status should be viewed as if they are TDY. During their on-duty month, honor guard members will have total exemption from base exercises and be released from their duty section to perform military honors at funeral, memorial services, and other honor guard ceremonies and to take part in mandatory honor guard training. In the event of real world exercise recalls, alerts or responses, the on-duty honor guard members will report to the honor guard administration facility. All off-duty and stand-by members will report to their primary work places. All funeral details will be covered with on-duty members during this time: however, stand-by and off-duty members may be used in extreme cases with simultaneous details.

5.1.4. Honor guard members residing in base dormitories are exempt from bay orderly duties during their on-duty and stand-by months (but not during off-duty months). It is the member's responsibility to resolve any schedule conflicts.

5.1.5. During a normal duty week, members of the on-duty flight will either be on a detail, at honor guard for training, performing vehicle and weapon maintenance or physical conditioning, unless the flight chief with concurrence of the OIC/Superintendent approves time off for compensation.

5.2. Excused Absences. Acceptable reasons for an excused absence from a detail or honor guard meeting include leave, mission-essential duty, TDY and quarters. These should all be coordinated through the member's flight chief and honor guard OIC/Superintendent.

5.2.1. Leave. Any period of leave must be coordinated with the member's flight chief and honor guard OIC/Superintendent. Members will coordinate ordinary scheduled leave with their flight chief no less than 3 days prior to taking leave. Honor guard members will not take leave during their on-duty month without the permission of their respective flight chief and honor guard OIC/Superintendent. Leave while on-duty is discouraged but can be approved if the situation warrants.

5.2.2. Mission-Essential Duty. For the purpose of this instruction, mission essential means a member is required to perform a specific task during a specific period of time and the task cannot be performed by another individual from the member's duty section nor can the member perform the task at a different time. The unit should ensure the honor guard member is not tasked as mission essential on a routine basis. The member should be available to perform honor guard duties during the member's on-duty or stand-by months. If not, the first sergeant will be contacted for a replacement member.

5.2.3. Quarters. When a member has been restricted to quarters by competent medical authority, the flight chief must be notified and a copy of the paperwork will be provided to the OIC/Superintendent to be placed in the member's record.

5.2.4. TDY. Member is performing temporary duty and is outside the local area. Units should work any scheduled TDY around the members schedule to allow full commitment to honor guard.

5.3. Participation in details will be evenly distributed between all members within a flight. Assignment to details will be made regardless of race, creed, color, sex, national origin or religious preference.

5.4. Tardiness will not be tolerated. Members are expected to arrive no later than 10 minutes early and in the appropriate uniform with all required equipment. Failure to participate in details, scheduled meetings, and failure to coordinate scheduled leave will result in disciplinary action, which may result in the member's release from the honor guard.

5.5. Use of tobacco products will not take place at any honor guard detail location. Team members may stop for a tobacco break while in route to the detail location and when in route back to Maxwell AFB. While at honor guard, smoking is permitted in designated areas only.

5.6. Consumption of alcoholic beverages will not be allowed in any government-owned or controlled vehicle or be consumed at any time during the detail from initial formation to returning to the assembly point.

6. Uniforms. According to AFI 34-242, the USAF Honor Guard establishes uniform standards for all base honor guards. Deviations are not authorized without written exception to policy waiver from the USAF Honor Guard/CC. The appropriate wear of honor guard ceremonial uniform items is identified in the USAF Honor Guard Training Guide.

6.1. The 42 FSS/FSOMX will submit a list of names to the UNICOR linen services, identifying members who are entitled to receive uniform cleaning on a quarterly basis. Members will turn in their uniforms regularly to ensure the uniform is clean and serviceable.

6.2. Necessary honor guard uniform accessories for issue will be maintained in an orderly manner by the honor guard Superintendent in an appropriate storage location.

6.3. Questions related to honor guard uniforms will be directed to the flight chief or honor guard OIC/Superintendent.

7. Equipment. Sufficient honor guard equipment will be obtained, maintained and controlled by the honor guard OIC/Superintendent to meet the requirements set forth in AFI 34-242 and AFI 36-2903. The honor guard OIC/Superintendent will ensure that all honor guard equipment is kept in good condition at all times and that necessary replacement items are ordered and received in a timely manner.

7.1. This equipment will include, but not be limited to:

7.1.1. M-14 rifles--serviceable weapons (with back-up weapons to allow for repairs) to equip five 3-member firing parties. Sufficient quantity of blank ammunition available to provide for honors training and ceremonial requirements. Rifles and blank ammunition will be stored in the honor guard armory. While in transit, weapons will not be left unattended. Weapons will be cleared at honor guard before being loaded in the weapon case, cleared upon issue at the detail, cleared after the detail before being loaded back into the weapon case and cleared once the team has returned to the honor guard facility. The flight chief or detail NCOIC will ensure that all spent casings are recovered before departing the detail location. Upon request from the PADD/NOK, casings may be presented to the family after the flag presentation.

7.1.2. Sabers. There will be 10 serviceable ceremonial sabers and scabbards.

7.1.3. Harnesses. There will be a minimum of four flag harnesses in serviceable condition.

7.1.4. Colors and Standards. There will be a minimum of two sets of US and Air Force ceremonial flags and four flag stands.

7.1.5. Uniform items. There will be enough gloves, service caps, aiguillettes, ceremonial belts, insignias, cap covers, and taps for at least 30 members.

7.2. The honor guard OIC/Superintendent is responsible for equipping honor guard members. Members are responsible for notifying the flight chief of all equipment needs.

8. Weapons Storage. Weapons will be stored in the weapons storage room in the honor guard facility.

8.1. An approved clearing barrel must be present. Refer to AFMAN 31-229, *USAF Weapons Handling Manual*.

8.2. The honor guard Superintendent will ensure that a valid access roster is posted, identifying the members who have access to the storage facility.

8.3. M-14 rifles, operational and inert, will be stored, handled, issued and maintained with equal sensitivity.

9. Weapons Maintenance. Combat arms personnel must inspect the M-14s for serviceability once a year. The Superintendent will schedule this inspection, ensure that any discrepancies are corrected in a timely manner and reported to the OIC.

10. Transportation. The honor guard van will be used for all funerals (retiree & veteran) and all details within the Maxwell AFB AOR.

10.1. The honor guard vans must present a professional appearance and be in good mechanical condition at all times. The flight chief is responsible for ensuring the flight cleans and maintains the vans while on duty. The vans will be cleaned inside and out, at least once a week and at the end of an on-duty month. The AF Form 1800, *Operator's Inspection Guide and Trouble Report*, must be properly filled out each time the van is used.

10.2. All other transportation needed, outside of the use of the honor guard vans, will be requested from and provided by 42 LRS/LGRVO (493-5038) when assets are available. When a bus is requested, transportation will provide a driver if available. Privately owned vehicles will not be used for any detail outside the boundaries of Maxwell AFB without the approval of the honor guard OIC/Superintendent. **NOTE: Weapons will be transported in Government vehicles only.** Use of tobacco products will not be allowed in any government-owned or controlled vehicle. Alcoholic beverages will not be allowed in any government-owned or controlled vehicle or be consumed at any time during the detail from initial formation to returning to the assembly point. Government vehicles are authorized for transport to and from scheduled details and are not authorized in residential areas.

10.3. Return vehicles in the same condition as received. Honor guard members will clean the vehicle of visible dirt, bugs, salt and mud. All trash will be removed. Upon returning the vehicles, circumstances may prevent members from cleaning the vehicles prior to turn in (e.g., returning to the area late at night from details, immediate requirements to report to work, wear of service dress, etc.). Members will discuss their situation with the 42 LRS/LGRVO vehicle dispatcher and request to be released from immediately cleaning the vehicle. The honor guard members will clean the vehicle on the following duty day provided the vehicle is not reserved. Honor guard members may make other special arrangements with 42 LRS/LGRVO concerning cleaning vehicle.

11. Benefits and Awards. Honor guard members are recognized for their outstanding support by a recognition program. The recognition program includes:

11.1. The Air Force Achievement Medal (AFAM) is awarded to deserving members after completing 1 year of distinguished service for the Maxwell AFB Honor Guard team. The honor guard Superintendent or 42 FSS/FSOMX staff is responsible for ordering the DECOR 6. The Superintendent/FSOMX staff is responsible for preparing the award and submitting it for staffing and approval. Consideration for the achievement medal will be based upon the individual's overall performance and adherence to standards while completing a minimum of 45 military funerals and 5 ceremonial details as a member on the honor guard.

11.2. The Air Force Commendation Medal is awarded to exceptional members after completing no less than 2 years of service for the Maxwell AFB Honor Guard team where or where the member served as a flight chief and the AFAM was not awarded during their service time. The 42 FSS/FSOMX staff is responsible for ordering the DECOR 6. The Superintendent/FSOMX staff is responsible for preparing the award and submitting it for staffing and approval. Consideration for the commendation medal will be based upon the individual's overall performance and adherence to standards while serving on the honor guard.

11.3. The honor guard awards program consists of quarterly and annual awards. The quarterly award is presented to the member who excels for a specific quarter. The annual awards recognize the member of the year. Annual winners may be selected from the member of the quarter, but are not limited to those individuals (e.g., one member may be consistently superior, but not receive a quarterly award). The awards are 42 ABW level awards and do not compete at lower levels. Flight chiefs are responsible for submitting nominees from their respective flights.

11.4. The Superintendent/FSOMX staff is responsible for preparing the award and submitting it for staffing and approval.

11.5. The honor guard "Sharp Airman" award is a monthly award given by the honor guard OIC or 42 FSS/CC to the honor guard member who consistently displayed excellence during details, training and uniform inspections.

11.6. Full honor guard modified service dress uniform and honor guard team unique items are presented at no cost to the member. Unique items such as T-shirts and polos will be presented to members once fully qualified and performing as a flight member.

11.7. Dry cleaning and alterations for honor guard ceremonial and utility uniforms will be provided at no cost to the member. Alterations include change of rank when promoted.

11.8. Members receive a parking pass for use at the Base Exchange, Commissaries and other participating base organizations.

12. Performance Feedback. Flight chiefs will conduct personal feedback sessions on a quarterly basis with honor guard members. Flight chiefs will tell members what is expected from them, how well they are doing and what improvements they can make. Additionally, if members observe each other making mistakes during details, they will make corrective actions in a tactful manner. Remember, the honor guard is a team that takes care of its members.

13. Honor Guard Details. All honor guard members are subject to perform details at any time, regardless of flight status. On certain occasions, individuals from other flights (a flight not on-duty or stand-by) may be selected to perform a detail. This will be kept to a minimum. Honor guard members may be required to perform details on weekends, may receive short-notice notification of an upcoming detail and should be prepared to perform details and take actions to handle personal obligations and commitments.

14. Honors, Awards and Ceremonies. The guidelines for performing these functions are covered in the *USAF Honor Guard Basic Protocol, Honors and Ceremonies Training Guide*, updated as needed by AF Honor Guard. Additional information concerning the procedures for conducting honors is available in AFI 34-242, *Mortuary Affairs Program*.

15. The 42d Air Base Wing Commander (42 ABW/CC). The 42 ABW/CC:

15.1. Is responsible for the base honor guard program.

15.2. Provides funding and resources to meet operational requirements.

15.3. Provides storage, training and administrative space.

15.4. Determines the size of the honor guard unit.

15.5. Appoints the honor guard OIC/Superintendent. The wing commander will notify the selected individual by letter of his/her appointment.

15.6. Provides special recognition programs for honor guard members.

16. The Wing Chaplain. The Wing Chaplain or designee will, if requested by the PADD/NOK, ensure chapel support military funerals when possible. At a family's request, civilian clergy may be substituted for an Air Force Chaplain; families are encouraged to use their own clergy. Chaplain support includes active duty chaplains assigned to the installation, Air Force Reserve, Air National Guard, Civil Air Patrol and retired chaplains in the immediate area. All requests for chaplain support and for the use of military chapels for funeral services are made through the installation's Mortuary Affairs office.

17. The 42d Mission Support Group Commander (42 MSG/CC). The 42 MSG/CC will provide oversight of the honor guard for the 42 ABW/CC.

18. The 42d Force Support Squadron Commander (42 FSS/CC). The 42 FSS/CC will:

18.1. Manage the honor guard program for the installation commander.

18.2. Ensure data is entered into the FHDB IAW policy set forth in this instruction.

18.3. Identify and submit annual base level full-time honor guard manpower requirements (8G000) and advocate funding in the MAJCOM POM.

18.4. Work with the honor guard OIC/Superintendent to ensure operability of the base honor guard program.

BRIAN M. KILLOUGH, Colonel, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFMAN 31-229, *USAF Weapons Handling Manual*

AFI 34-242, *Mortuary Affairs Program*

AFPAM 34-505, *Mortuary Services Benefits for Retired Air Force Members*

AFMAN 36-2203, *Drill and Ceremonies*

AFI 36-2903, *Dress and Personal Appearance of Air Force Personnel*

AFI 36-2905, *Fitness Program*

Adopted Forms

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

AF Form 1800, *Operator's Inspection Guide and Trouble Report*

AF IMT 1946, *Honor Guard Checklist*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

42 ABW—42d Air Base Wing

42 MSG—42d Mission Support Group

42 FSS—42d Force Support Squadron

AFAM—Air Force Achievement Medal

AU—Air University

ABU—Airman Battle Uniform

CC—Commander

FHDB—Funeral Honors Database

NCOIC—Non-commissioned Officer in Charge

NFP—NCOIC of Firing Party

NPB—NCOIC of Pall bearers

NOK—Next of Kin

OIC—Officer in Charge

PADD—Person Authorized Direct Disposition

PCS—Permanent Change of Station

FSOM—Mortuary Affairs Office

FSOMX—Honor Guard OIC

TDY—Temporary Duty

UIF—Unfavorable Information File

Attachment 2

EXAMPLE HONOR GUARD DUTY STATEMENT OF UNDERSTANDING

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
42D AIR BASE WING (AETC)
MAXWELL AIR FORCE BASE ALABAMA

MEMORANDUM FOR HONOR GUARD APPLICANT SRA ROBERT J. HARRIS

FROM: 42 FSS/FSOMX

SUBJECT: Honor Guard Duty Statement of Understanding

1. Members of the Maxwell AFB Honor Guard must maintain certain standards at all times. Specific uniform and training standards are detailed below. Members that are selected as the unit representative must not be on a profile when reporting as a new member; if on a profile they will be sent back to their unit for a replacement.

a. Members are issued a full uniform altered to specifications prescribed by the USAF Honor Guard. Males and females will wear the ceremonial uniform with pants and the light-blue short-sleeve shirt. The honor guard will provide all other special clothing items designated by AFI 36-2903, *Dress and Personal Appearance of Air Force Personnel*, the USAF Base Honor Guard Training Manual, AFI 34-242, *Mortuary Affairs Program*, and 42 FSS/CC. Members are required to have an honor guard uniform ready at all times.

b. Members will adhere to dress and appearance standards IAW AFI 36-2903 and the USAF Base Honor Guard Training Manual. Inspections will be conducted before every on-call training session and prior to each detail performance to ensure compliance. Members are expected to become proficient in all areas of training. Substandard performance will result in removal from the team. Adverse actions taken by the unit against members can be cause for dismissal from the honor guard, and/or cause the member to forfeit their opportunities to receive a medal regardless of their performance.

c. The honor guard commitment is a period of 12 months. Members will be temporary duty assigned (TDA) to the honor guard for the months they are on-call. There is also stand-by periods that members will be required to perform as well during the course of the year. Members should immediately notify the honor guard OIC or Superintendent upon receipt of PCS/PCA notification. Members will not be released from honor guard without a trained and uniformed replacement from their assigned unit. New members will go through a 2 week training and evaluation period. During this time they are trained and certified and will attend funerals as an observer when practical. They may also perform as a team member during training. The current member, if desiring to be replaced, should be actively involved in ensuring their replacement is secured.

2. Members of the honor guard are required to attend ALL scheduled training sessions and special meetings. **Official honor guard duty, including training, takes precedence over military duties when the base mission is not adversely affected. All events and details members are tasked with are mandatory formations**. The flight training/practice days are scheduled for the 3 duty days at the end of each month. The flight chief may call for more training days during the month if deemed necessary. The member's current and subsequent

supervisors must release them to attend. Notify your flight chief at least 1 day prior to training/practice if you will not be able to attend. It is the responsibility of the member to attend these training days and to keep their supervisor informed.

3. Members will have their physical training (PT) gear available. On normal duty days, if a member is not assigned to a detail, they will be present at the honor guard facilities for practice and to ensure that all resources are cleaned and in ready condition. Members will be required to participate in PT while on honor guard.

4. Members receive incentives, such as designated parking at the Maxwell BX and Gunter Commissary, free dry cleaning and alterations of all uniform items through UNICOR, and consideration for the Air Force Achievement Medal for at least 12 months of honorable service. Picnics and an annual BBQ are held for members to relax and to mingle with members from other flights that they may not normally get to work with. This is also a time for unit First Sergeants and Chiefs to meet and greet with the team.

5. Without delay, you must coordinate emergency leave, mission essential TDY and PME Schools with the honor guard OIC or Superintendent. Ordinary leave, passes or permissive TDY will be handled on a case by case basis.

Danny J. Bradberry
DANNY J. BRADBERRY, MSgt, USAF
Superintendent

1st Ind, SrA Robert J. Harris 1 Jun 10

MEMORANDUM FOR 42 FSS/FSOMX

Effective 1 Jun 10, I understand and will comply with all policies as outlined above. **I certify that I do not have an unfavorable information file, that I am not on a control roster and that I am not on a profile.**

Robert J. Harris
ROBERT J. HARRIS, SrA, USAF
Maxwell AFB Honor Guard Applicant

2nd Ind, Unit/Office Symbol [Immediate Supervisor] 5 Jun 10

MEMORANDUM FOR 42 FSS/FSOMX

I agree to release SrA Smith for scheduled training sessions, commander's calls and assigned details. Further, I understand that attendance at details and training has precedence over normal duties when the base's mission is not adversely affected and verification of detail assignments may be obtained by contacting the honor guard office.

Terry L. White
TERRY L. WHITE, TSgt, USAF
[Duty Title]

3rd Ind, Unit/CCF 9 Jun 10

MEMORANDUM FOR 42 FSS/FSOMX

I agree with the above requirements and fully support this membership. I verify that SrA Smith does not have an unfavorable information file, is not on a control roster and is not on a profile. I will notify the honor guard immediately in the event that SrA Smith becomes disqualified from bearing arms as a result of administrative or judicial action, is placed on a control roster or has a UIF or is placed on a profile.

Frank N. Watson
FRANK N. WATSON, MSgt, USAF
Unit First Sergeant

4th Ind, Unit/CC 11 Jun 10

MEMORANDUM FOR 42 FSS/FSOMX

I agree with the above requirements and fully support this membership. I will notify the Honor Guard immediately in the event that SrA Smith becomes disqualified from bearing arms as a result of administrative or judicial action.

Mary L. Brown
MARY L. BROWN, Maj, USAF
Unit Commander

5th Ind, Honor Guard Superintendent 13 Jun 10

MEMORANDUM FOR 42 FSS/FSOMX

I fully support this membership.

Danny J. Bradberry
DANNY J. BRADBERRY, MSgt, USAF
Honor Guard Superintendent